

TOPIC 1: WORLD WAR ONE/FIRST WORLD WAR/GREAT WAR

1. Background
2. Causes of WW1 : Long term causes
Short term causes
3. Course of WW1
4. Results of WW1 : Social Results
Economic Results
Political Results

BACKGROUND

- World War one was a global war centred in Europe which started on 28 July 1914 and lasted until 11 November 1918.
- It was predominantly called World War One or The Great War from its occurrence until the start of World War Two in 1939, and the First World War thereafter.
- It involved all the world's great powers which were assembled in two **opposing/hostile** alliances: the Allied Powers/ Allies (based on the Triple Entente of Britain , France and Russia) and the Central Powers (originally the Triple Alliance of Germany, Italy and Austria – Hungary.)
- These alliances both re-organized (Italy fought for the Allies) and expanded as more nations entered the war.
- Ultimately, more than 70 million military personnel, including 60million Europeans, were mobilized in one of the largest wars in history.
- More than 9 million combatants were killed, mainly because of technological advancements that led to enormous increases in the lethality of weapons without corresponding improvements in protection or mobility.
- World War one subsequently paved the way for various political changes, such as revolutions in many of the nations involved.

Long Term Causes of World War One (SUMMARIZED)

- The system of alliances initiated by Bismarck caused the First World War.
- The colonial clashes or conflicts by European powers caused the 1914 war.
- The naval race especially between Britain and Germany increased tension in Europe.
- Arms race by European powers increased enmity among European powers.
- Militarism in Europe also caused the 1914 war.
- Nationalism was another cause of world war one.
- The first Moroccan crisis [1905] and the second Moroccan crisis [1911] also contributed.
- German Weltpolitik [a policy aimed at dominating Europe] also caused this war.
- War plans such as the Schlieffen plan by Germany caused the 1914 war.

Long Term Causes of World War One (DETAILED)

- In order to have a full appreciation of the outbreak of the Great War in 1914, it is vital to briefly examine the existing or prevailing social and political conditions that created a war situation in the world.

1. First Moroccan Crisis, 1905

- Problems started when Britain recognized French ambitions in Morocco as part of the Entente Cordiale Agreement of 1904.
- The Entente Cordiale was an agreement between Britain and France in which Britain recognized French interests in Morocco and France recognized British interests in Egypt.
- The Entente Cordiale was not a military agreement.
- As soon as the Kaiser gained information of the secret clause on Morocco, which meant exclusion of German interests in Morocco, strong diplomatic pressure was brought to bear on France.
- The Kaiser visited Tangier in 1905 and assured the Sultan that Germany would support the independence of Morocco and did not intend to recognize any other agreement.
- Kaiser demanded the calling of a European conference on Morocco.
- The conference was held at Algeciras, Spain in 1906.

The Algeciras Conference of 1906

- ✓ This conference was held in Spain.
- ✓ It was attended by Britain, France, Germany, Austria-Hungary, Spain, Russia and Italy.
- ✓ At this conference it became clear that British backing for France was real.
- ✓ At this conference the Kaiser was humiliated. He had wanted to appear as a major power in Africa.
- ✓ Instead, his views were rejected.
- ✓ He was particularly bitter about the way he was treated, as if he had no right to speak on such matters.
- ✓ Only Austria-Hungary supported her, the rest supported French control of Morocco.
- ✓ It was agreed that Morocco should remain independent, but French and Spanish police forces were to keep order there.
- ✓ The Kaiser who felt humiliated vowed to reverse the decision when Germany's navy was powerful enough.

Terms of the Algeciras Conference of 1906

- Policing of Morocco was to be placed under France and Spain.
- Morocco was placed under international control.
- France was free to proceed with its peaceful penetrations.
- The State Bank of Morocco was to be controlled by Britain, France, Germany and Spain.
- Germany got trading rights in Morocco.
- The independence of the Sultan of Morocco was recognised.
- The principle of open door for all countries was recognised.

2. SECOND MOROCCAN CRISIS/ PANTHER CRISIS OF 1911

- The Kaiser William II had been disappointed by the outcome of the Algeciras conference in 1906.
- In 1908, the French secured the election of a new Sultan of Morocco because the previous one was against the French policy in Morocco.
- In 1911, the Moroccan tribes rebelled against this new Sultan and in order to suppress it, the French forces occupied the Moroccan capital, Fez.
- In 1911, claiming that Algeria was endangered by disorder in Morocco; French troops occupied FEZ which was under attack from nomadic tribes.
- FEZ was the capital of Morocco at that time.
- Germany denounced the French move as illegal according to the Algeciras conference.
- In July 1911, the Kaiser sensing danger of total control of Morocco by France sent a German gunboat called the Panther, to the west coast port of Morocco of Agadir claiming to protect Germans who lived there but there were none.
- The real reasons were [a] to frighten France into giving her some colonial territory in compensation for the likely occupation of the whole of Morocco by France. [b] Germany also wanted to test the strength of the Anglo-French Entente of 1904.
- Germany claimed that she was protecting her interests in Morocco and demanded all of French Congo as compensation.
- For a time, feelings were so high that war between France and Germany seemed possible.
- German action excited British opinion as Agadir was close to Gibraltar.
- Britain immediately sided with France in the crisis.
- British fleet was prepared for action.
- This forced Germany to withdraw embarrassed, as it was clearly a French victory. (A diplomatic defeat for Germany and a diplomatic victory for France.)
- An agreement was reached whereby France was recognized as giving a protectorate over Morocco but in return the German Cameroons were enlarged by two substantial slices from the French Middle Congo.

Contribution of the Moroccan Crisis to the outbreak of World War One

- It made/caused Germany to speed up her war preparations.
- Although war was averted it was only a matter of postponement.
- French hopes of a better relationship with Germany were wrecked.
- It led to further division of Europe into two hostile camps.
- The relationship between Britain and France was further strengthened. Britain and France signed a naval agreement in 1912.
- The British and French realised that they had to take a firm stand against the Kaiser's bullying tactics.

-It increased opposition against Germany in Europe.

3. BOSNIAN CRISIS OF 1908

- After the Congress of Berlin in 1878, Austria-Hungary was given the mandate to govern Bosnia and Herzegovina.
- On the other hand Serbia wanted to control them since the inhabitants of the two provinces were Serbs/ Slavs.
- The Young Turks' central aim was to revitalise the weakening Turkish / Ottoman Empire and then maintain the autocracy.
 - In 1908 there was the Young Turks revolt against the Turkish Sultan.
- The revolution shocked the major powers of Europe, especially Russia and Austria-Hungary since a strong Turkey would disturb their interests.
- Such a strong Turkish government could make Austria-Hungary lose her control over Bosnia and Herzegovina.
- Austria- Hungary took advantage of the political instability and annexed Bosnia and Herzegovina, the two provinces she had been administering since 1878.
- This was a blow to Serbia which was encouraging Slav nationalism and wanted to acquire the two provinces which had three million Serbs.
- Serbia wanted to create a South Slav State i.e. Yugoslavia.
- Serbia appealed for help from fellow Slavs.
- Serbia mobilized her army against Austria- Hungary.
- Russia called for a European conference and expected support from Britain and France.
- Russia mobilized in support of Serbia.
- Germany declared that she would assist Austria- Hungary militarily if she was attacked.
- Russia alone could not fight Austria because she had not fully recovered from the defeat in the Russo- Japanese war of 1904 to 1905.
- When it became clear that Germany would support Austria, Russia demobilized.
- The crisis increased the tension between Serbia and Austria- Hungary.
- Austria- Hungary kept Bosnia and Herzegovina.
- It humiliated Russia as well.
- The Bosnian Crisis led to the formation of the famous **terrorist** group, **Black Hand** or **Union of Death**.

Contribution of the Bosnian Crisis to the outbreak of World War One

- It encouraged Russia to increase her army further.
- It worsened relations between Germany and Russia.
- The enmity between Russia and Austria-Hungary was increased.
- It increased tension between Serbia and Austria-Hungary that at any given time the two countries would fight over Bosnia and Herzegovina.
- It led to the formation of the Black Hand.

4. ALLIANCE SYSTEMS

- An alliance is an agreement made between two or more countries to give each other help if it is needed.
- When an alliance is signed, those countries are known as **Allies**.
- A number of alliances had been signed by different countries between 1879 and 1914.
- These were important because they meant that some countries had no option but to declare war if one of their allies declared war first.
- A number of examples are given below to explain the concept of alliances.

Dual Alliance of 1879

- Germany and Austria-Hungary made an alliance to protect themselves from Russia.

Terms of this treaty

- The two countries promised each other mutual aid if one of them was attacked by Russia.
- The two promised mutual aid if one of them was attacked by any power assisted by Russia.
- They promised each other aid if either of them were attacked by two or more powers.
- They promised each other neutrality in the case of an attack by any other country, for example, France.
- The treaty clearly promised support to Germany in the event of a joint attack by France and Russia.

Austro-Serbia Alliance of 1881

- Austria-Hungary made alliance with Serbia to stop Russia from gaining control of Serbia.

1882 Triple Alliance

- Germany and Austria-Hungary made an alliance with Italy to stop Italy from taking sides with Russia.

It was signed by Germany, Austria-Hungary and Italy. It was an enlargement of the 1879 Dual Alliance to include Italy. Italy joined because she resented/hated French expansion in North Africa. Bismarck secretly encouraged French ambitions in North Africa, mainly to divert her from scheming to recover Alsace-Lorraine and to bring France into collision with Italy, who had ambitions and some 20 000 settlers in Tunis area. In 1881 the French reluctant to see an Italian colony established on the borders of French Algeria, took Bismarck's hint and occupied Tunis. This threw Italy into the arms of Germany and the following year [1882] Italy joined the two powers of the 1879 Dual Alliance to form the Triple Alliance.

Terms of this Treaty

- Germany and Austria-Hungary agreed to help Italy if she were attacked by France.
- Italy agreed to help Germany if she were attacked by France.
- Each of these powers agreed to help if either of the powers were attacked by any two or more powers.
- Germany and Austria-Hungary agreed that they would help each other against a Russian attack of either of them.
- In case of any war that involved Britain, Italy was to remain neutral.
- Each of these powers agreed to remain neutral if either of them was attacked by a single power.
- The alliance was joined in the following year [1883] by Romania and later on by Turkey.

Franco-Russian Alliance of 1894

- Russia formed an alliance with France to protect herself against Germany and Austria- Hungary.

It was signed by Russia and France. France was without an ally but by 1890 she felt she needed one, partly because of her weakness in relation to Germany and partly because she was increasingly coming into conflict with Great Britain and Italy over colonial matters. Russia had a tradition of an alliance with Germany but she had come to realise that whenever Austrian and Russian interests clashed in the Balkans, Germany was likely to support Austria. Therefore in 1890 when her existing treaty with Germany lapsed, she did not renew it. The dismissal of Bismarck in 1890 marked a turning point in the relations of European countries. French isolation died a natural death as a result of Kaiser's policies. When the Re-insurance treaty needed to be renewed in 1890, Kaiser William ignored. Russia signed the Dual Alliance with France because since 1888 Russia was being given French loans, which greatly helped her to finance her industrial progress.

Terms of this Treaty

- If France was attacked by Germany alone or by Germany and Italy, Russia would help her.
- If Russia was attacked by Germany alone or by Germany and Austria-Hungary, France would help her.
- The alliance was to continue as long as the triple alliance was in force [a clear indication that they were geared towards a war].
- If the members of the triple alliance mobilised, France and Russia were to mobilise immediately.

Entente Cordiale of 1904

- This was an agreement but not a formal alliance, between France and Britain.

Triple Entente of 1907

- This was made between Russia, France and Britain to counter the increasing threat from Germany.
 - It was signed by Britain, France and Russia. France brought her two friends together. Britain and Russia ironed out their differences. The support given by Russia to France and Britain at Algeciras Conference in 1906 drew them together. This alliance was described as the anti-German club of Britain, Russia and France. This alliance was meant to counter the triple alliance.

Terms of this Treaty

- They agreed to divide Persia [Iran] into three spheres of influence.
- The Northern sphere including Tehran was to be under Russian influence.
- The Southern sphere was to be under British influence.
- Tibet which was of interest to both was declared to be neutral.
- They agreed that neither of them would interfere in Tibet's internal affairs.
- China's sovereignty was to be recognised.
- A complete balance of power was struck.

Contribution of the Alliance System to the outbreak of World War One.

- It called for the inconvenience of many countries because of the feeling of insecurity.
- Bismarck's alliances helped to increase the fears of other nations especially France, which began a frantic search for allies to counter the triple alliance.
- It led to the division of Europe into two armed and equally opposing camps, that is, triple alliance and triple entente.
- The two camps increased strength year after year.
- The relations between the two camps worsened.
- The alliances operated to convert a local quarrel into a general war.
- These two camps were the ones that fought the war of 1914.
- The armies ready for war on the continent were the largest ever formed in Europe in time of peace.

Triple Entente of 1914

- Britain, France and Russia agreed not to sign for peace separately.
- By 1914, Europe had been divided into two **antagonistic** camps namely the Triple Alliance of Germany, Austria and Italy and the Triple Entente of Britain, France and Russia.
- Without the alliances, probably the quarrel between Austria and Serbia would not have degenerated into a world war due to two possible reasons :

- i) Serbia was so small and much weaker than Austria- Hungary that she could have been crushed.
 - ii) Serbia could have accepted the whole ultimatum sent by Austria after the Sarajevo incident and war would have been avoided.
- However, this was not possible because each little or small power was in one way or the other allied to one of the major powers which were in turn members of either the Triple Alliance or Triple Entente.
 - This implied or meant that a conflict between a small power supported by the Triple Alliance and another small power with the backing of the Triple Entente would suck in the major powers from the opposite sides.

5. COLONIAL RIVALRY/ COLLISIONS IN AFRICA AND THE FAR EAST/ IMPERIALISM

- Imperialism is when a country takes over new lands or other countries and makes them subject to their rule.
- By 1900, the British Empire had extended over five continents and France had control over larger areas of Africa.
- With the rise of industrialism, countries needed new markets.
- The amount of land owned by Britain and France increased the rivalry with Germany who had entered the scramble to acquire colonies late and only acquired small areas of Africa.
- Several conflicts between major powers over colonies contributed to the heightening of international tension as was shown by the following notable examples.
 - i) The Russo-Japanese conflicts in China of 1905
 - ii) The conflict over Morocco between France and Germany (1905 and 1911)
 - iii) Austria –Hungary clashed with Russia over the Balkans.
- In all the above examples international tension was worsened and therefore imperialism played a **pivotal/ crucial** role in causing the outbreak of the First World War.

6. MILITARY RIVALRY/ MILITARISM

- Militarism means that military forces are given a high profile by the government OR military personnel have a high level of influence on ideas of the government or policies of a country/state.
- For the purpose of power and prestige, and for the defence of nationalism and imperialism, nations developed large armies and navies.
- The growing European divide had led to an arms race between the main countries.
- The armies of both France and Germany had more than doubled between 1870 and 1914 and there was fierce competition between Britain and Germany for the control and mastery of the Seas.
- The British had introduced the **Dreadnought**, an effective battleship, in 1906.
- The Germans soon followed suit introducing their own battleships.

- Germany had emerged from its wars of unification in 1870 with the largest and strongest army in Europe, and this army was retained not only to defend the new nation from possible attack, especially from defeated France, but also as a symbol of German greatness.
- Other countries followed suit and by the start of the 19th century, European Nations possessed larger peacetime armies than at any other stage in history.
- Many people across the world were eager to let the rest of the world know how strong and important their country was.
- Compulsory military training was typical of all countries and vast amounts of money were being spent annually on armaments.
- German, Russian and Italian defence expenditure rose thrice in twenty years before the war broke out while that of Britain and Austria more than doubled.
- France also increased her expenditure.
- By 1914, there were over three and half a million soldiers in Europe and millions more were trained reserves.
- As each country tried to ensure its own security by increasing the size of the army, the nervous tensions grew and the danger/ possibility of war grew
- The Schlieffen plan drawn up by the Germany Army chief of staff, Von Schlieffen, involved attacking France through Belgium if Russia made an attack on Germany.
- The plan, first approved in 1905 and modified in 1911 by von Moltke, assumed that France would automatically join Russia, so that the bulk of German forces were to be sent through Belgium to knock out France in Six weeks.

THE SCHLIEFFEN PLAN IN DETAIL

- The plan aimed at capturing Paris, the French capital in very short space of time before returning to Russia after 39 days only.
- The plan of attack was called the Schlieffen plan.
- It was revised in 1905.
- Germany troops were to march through Belgium within twelve days.
- The plan was devised in such a way as to avoid fighting on two fronts.
- The plan aimed at capturing Brussels, the Belgian capital within 19 days.
- Germany soldiers were to occupy channel ports in order to prevent the landing of British reinforcements.
- It was aimed at preventing the invasion of Alsace – Lorraine.
- The plan was to concentrate an overwhelming proportion of their forces in the west to knock out France and then turn east to deal with Russia.
- German superiority in numbers, organization, training and equipment carried all before it.

7. NATIONALISM

- Nationalism means the desire to achieve political independence, especially by a country under foreign control or by a people with a separate identity and culture but no state of their own.

- The congress of Vienna, held after Napoleon's exile, aimed at sorting out problems in Europe.
- Delegates from Britain, Austria, Prussia and Russia (the winning allies) decided upon a new Europe that left both Germany and Italy as divided states.
- Strong nationalist elements led to the re-unification of Italy in 1861 and Germany in 1871.
- The settlement at the end of the Franco – Prussian war left France angry at the loss of Alsace – Lorraine.
- Large areas of both Austria- Hungary and Serbia were home to different nationalist groups, all of whom wanted freedom from the states in which they lived.

8. THE NAVAL RACE

- The only country that was not involved in the race to build up armies was Britain
- The British had always relied on their navy to defend their islands from foreign attack, and ever since Drake had defeated the Spanish Armada some three and half centuries earlier, the British Navy had been the almost unquestioned “mistress of the seas.”
- However, the German colonial ambitions required the development and growth of a strong navy to support them and the growth of the German Navy after 1897 was regarded by Britain as a direct threat to her sea power.
- Believing that, for her safety, her navy needed to be as large as the combined fleets of any two European powers, Britain embarked on a vast ship building programme.
- She developed a new type of battleship called the “Dreadnought” with such strength and firepower that no other ship could come within range of it without being blown out of water.
- When the Germans began to build a similar type of ship, the naval race developed in earnest.
- The British believed that the only reason for the greatest military nation in the world to build a great navy was because it intended to use the army outside Europe.
- In 1912, to offset the growing German naval threat, Britain agreed to defend the North Sea while France safeguarded the interests of both countries in the Mediterranean.
- It was not likely that international competition in the building of navies would in itself cause a war but as European nations devoted increasing sums of money to military expenditure and were obviously becoming increasingly more prepared for war, the actual danger of the war also increased.

9. The Balkan Wars

CAUSES OF THE FIRST BALKAN WAR

- The Balkan League wanted to drive Turkey out of the Balkans.
- League members wanted to obtain a portion of the territory under Turkey

a) First Balkan War of 1912

- On 12 October 1912 the First Balkan League which comprised of Greece, Serbia, Montenegro and Bulgaria declared war on Turkey.
- They gained a swift victory.
- They drove Turks out of most of the European territory of the Balkans.
- The Turkish government attempted to introduce a common law, a national language and so on.
- In addition, real power in Turkey rested with a few ambitious army officers who suppressed the subject peoples.
- The renewed Turkish persecution forced the Balkan states to cast their rivalry and jealousies.
- All these caused resentment to the minorities against Turkey.
- The Balkan League wanted to drive Turkey out of all her European territories.
- Each member of the Balkan League hoped to obtain a portion of the territory still under Turkish rule.
- The Balkan states witnessed the weaknesses of Turkey when it fought with Italy in 1911 in Libya.
- The Italians had declared war on Turkey in 1911 and attacked the Turkish province and very quickly defeated the Turkish forces.
- When the Serbians and Bulgarians captured Adrianople, Turkey was forced to make peace.
- Austria-Hungary and Germany had stood aside expecting that the Turks would defeat the Balkan League, but both had gravely miscalculated.
- Turkey was defeated in roughly 6 weeks.
- The great powers were shocked by this remarkable success of the Balkan states.
- They immediately called for a meeting in London to decide the future of the Balkan affairs

The Treaty of London [1913]

- By this treaty Turkey lost nearly the whole of her territory in Europe to the Balkan states.
- Greece was to get Thrace and Salonika.
- Serbia was to get a larger part of Macedonia.
- The Greek government felt cheated as it did not gain a larger territory in Macedonia.
- Bulgaria was dissatisfied by this treaty and was determined to revise this treaty.
- Each government felt it gained little.

- As a result, the First Balkan League [coalition] soon fell apart.
- Austria-Hungary was concentrating on the setting up of a small state, Albania in the Eastern part of Serbia to block Serbia from possessing a port in the Adriatic Sea.
- This angered Serbia as it was its key territorial objective since it was a landlocked country.

Balkan States involved in the First Balkan War

- | | |
|-------------|-----------|
| -Greece | -Serbia |
| -Montenegro | -Bulgaria |

Balkan States before World War One

- | | |
|--------------|-------------|
| -Albania | -Macedonia |
| -Bulgaria | -Serbia |
| -Greece | -Bosnia |
| -Herzegovina | -Montenegro |
| -Romania | -Thrace |
| -Crete | -Salonika |

Impact of the First Balkan War

- The first Balkan War contributed to increased tension in Europe.
- The first Balkan War weakened the Turkish Empire which might otherwise have kept Serbia under control. This tilted the balance of power in Europe in favour of Russia.
- Serbia was frustrated by its failure to get Albania because as a land-locked country it wanted to have access to the Adriatic Sea.
- The Greeks were also unhappy because they got a small part of Macedonia.
- Bulgaria also complained that it did not get enough territory.
- Russia felt humiliated that its ally Serbia did not get Albania.
- Germany had firmly supported Austria-Hungary in the creation of an independent Albania to stop Serbia from becoming too strong.



b) The Second Balkan War of 1913

- This war was fought over how to distribute the spoils of victory of the First Balkan War.
- Bulgaria was angry with the settlement [Treaty of London] of 1913.
- She was not satisfied by her spoils of the war.
- She felt other countries gained at her expense.
- Bulgaria greatly resented the Greeks getting Salonika.
- Bulgaria was not happy about Serbia being given part of Macedonia because these areas were supposed to have been part of Bulgaria's share of the spoils.
- Bulgaria claimed part of Macedonia which Serbia refused to give up.
- The war broke out in June 1913 when Bulgaria attacked Serbia.
- This forced Greece, Romania and Turkey to declare war on Bulgaria.
- Serbia, Greece and Romania had formed the Second Balkan League.
- The Turks joined the war because they had seen in this dispute an opportunity of regaining some of their lost European territory.
- In less than a month Bulgaria had been quite easily defeated.

The Treaty of Bucharest [1913]

- This treaty was signed after the Second Balkan War.
- Bucharest was the capital city of Romania.
- By this treaty, Serbia and Greece kept those parts of Macedonia, but under the Austro-Hungarian and Germany pressure.
- For its part, Turkey regained Adrianople. Bulgaria was forced to give up Adrianople.
- The Serbs were once again denied the Adriatic port.
- Romania got part of Bulgarian Dobruha.
- Austria-Hungary was again determined to keep Serbia landlocked.

Balkan States which took part in the Second Balkan War

- | | |
|-----------|-------------|
| -Serbia | -Greece |
| -Romania | -Montenegro |
| -Bulgaria | |

Contribution of the Balkan Wars to the outbreak of World War One

- The wars intensified bad relations between Serbia and Austria-Hungary.
- Austria-Hungary with German support was determined to suppress or to destroy Serbia.
- Serbia emerged from the war victorious, stronger, more confident and aggressive than ever.
- Austria-Hungary frustrated Serbian national aims when after the Balkan wars she insisted on the formation of Albania as an independent state on the Adriatic. This move deterred Serbian expansion to the Adriatic coastline. This means Austria-Hungary was determined to keep Serbia a landlocked country.
- The Serbs were now confident that the Austrians wanted to gain a continuous territory across the Peninsula from the Adriatic to the Aegean Sea and for this purpose Serbia which stood directly in their path would have to be removed from the map as an independent state.
- The wars made the Franco-Russian and the Austro-German commitments tighter.
- The Kaiser assured the Austrians of his support if they fought a war with Serbia [the so called blank cheque].
- Turkey of course would be relied upon to support such a move.
- Serbia began to encourage Pan-Slavism in Austria-Hungary while Austria-Hungary was determined to crush Slav nationalism in her country.
- Thus after the two Balkan wars, Austria-Hungary was prepared to wage a preventive war while Serbia was prepared to wage a war of liberation.

Balkan States that had become independent from Turkey by 1912

- | | |
|-------------|----------|
| -Montenegro | -Romania |
| -Bulgaria | -Serbia |

- | | |
|------------|----------|
| -Greece | -Albania |
| -Macedonia | -Thrace |
| -Salonika | -Crete |

Ethnic Groups in the Balkan States

- | | |
|-----------------------|---------------|
| -Albanians | -Serbs |
| -Bulgarians / Bulgars | -Greeks |
| -Macedonians | -Croats |
| -Bosnians | -Montenegrins |
| -Romani / Romanians | |

SHORT TERM CAUSE(S) OF WORLD WAR ONE

- The First World War began in August 1914.
- It was directly triggered by the assassination of the Austrian Archduke, Francis Ferdinand who was heir to the Austro- Hungarian throne together with his pregnant wife, Sophie.
- They had three children.
- Francis Ferdinand was, however, very unpopular because he had made it clear that once he became Emperor he would make drastic changes to the Empire.
- Austria had annexed Bosnia in 1908, a move that was not popular with Bosnian people as about 3 million of them were Serbs.

SARAJEVO ASSASINATION / INCIDENT OF 28 JUNE 1914

- Francis Ferdinand decided to visit Sarajevo, the capital of Bosnia and Herzegovina, to make an inspection of the Austro- Hungarian troops there.
- The inspection was scheduled for 28 June 1914.
- It was planned that Francis Ferdinand and his wife Sophie would be met at the station and be taken by car to the city Hall where they would have lunch before going to inspect the troops.
- A Serbian terrorist group, called the ***Black Hand or Union of Death***, had met and decided that the Archduke should be assassinated and the planned visit provided the ideal opportunity.
- Seven young men who had been trained in bomb throwing and marksmanship were stationed along the route that Francis Ferdinand's car would follow from the city Hall to the inspection centre.
- The first two terrorists were unable to throw their grenades because the streets were too crowded and the car was travelling quite fast

- The third terrorist, a young man called Cadrinovic, threw a grenade which exploded under the car following that of the Archduke.
- Although the Archduke and his wife were unhurt, some of his attendants were injured and had to be taken to hospital.
- After lunch, at the city hall, Francis Ferdinand insisted on visiting the injured attendants in hospital.
- However, on the way to hospital, the driver took a wrong turn.
- Realizing his mistake, he stopped the car and began to reverse and this is when all hell broke loose.
- Another terrorist named Gavrillo Princip; again a member of Black Hand, an anti-Austrian organization allegedly sponsored by Serbia, stepped forward and fired two shots.
- The first shot hit the pregnant Sophia in the stomach, she died almost instantly.
- The second shot hit the Archduke in the neck, and he died a short while later.
- Gavrillo Princip was arrested but was not executed because he was under 20 years.
- He was sentenced to twenty years in prison where he died of tuberculosis (TB) in 1918.
- After the assassination of the Archduke and his wife, Austria sent an ultimatum (final demand) to Serbia which had three demands namely:
 - i) Serbia was to suppress all anti- Austrian terrorist organizations including Black Hand.
 - ii) Serbian police were to investigate the murder of the Archduke and his wife.
 - iii) Austrian officials were to be allowed to enter Serbia to make sure the first two demands were carried out.
- The Austrian chancellor welcomed the assassination as an excuse for war against Serbia by claiming that the Serbian government had planned the assassination though there was no evidence to show involvement of the Serbian government.
- Serbia accepted the first two demands and rejected the third one.
- Serbia offered to take part in an international conference to settle outstanding differences with Austria hence failing to meet demands of the ultimatum.
- Austria, with the promise of Germany support (blank cheque), declared war on Serbia on 28 July 1914
- The Russians, anxious not to let Serbia down ordered a general mobilization on 29 July 1914.
- The German government demanded Russia to cancel mobilization on 31 July 1914 and when Russia refused to comply, Germany declared war on Russia on 1 August 1914. France mobilized in support of Russia.
- Germany declared war on France on 3 August 1914.
- All these declarations of war signalled the start/ beginning of the Great War.
- The war was to have profound effects on the future of the world.

Contribution of the Sarajevo Assassination to the outbreak of World War One

- It increased enmity between Austria-Hungary and Serbia.
- It became the match stick that lit the bone fire.
- The incident showed the extent of German support for Austria-Hungary and Russian support

for Serbia.

- The event brought the clash between the Triple alliance and the Triple entente.
- The incident heightened Slav nationalism and the desire for self determination.
- It was important in that it started the war.
- There were many long term causes of the 1914 war but this incident came as an immediate cause.

Who was to blame for the outbreak of World War One? / Contribution or part played by European powers in the outbreak of World War One

a) Germany

- Bismarck's alliance system which was an attempt to isolate France led to the division of the world into two hostile camps. This made it difficult to localise the war.
- The German Schlieffen plan [war plan] was an indication that she was anticipating war.
- Germany took part in arms race which caused the war.
- German naval race with Britain caused the war.
- Kaiser's utterances provoked Britain, for example, he congratulated Paul Kruger after the Jameson raid failure.
- The colonial clash between Germany and France over Morocco in 1905 and 1911 caused tension.
- After the Sarajevo incident Germany gave Austria-Hungary a blank cheque to attack Serbia.
- Germany violated the neutrality of Belgium which brought Britain into the war.
- Germany supported Austria-Hungary in the Bosnian crisis.
- She fully backed Austria-Hungary's aggressiveness over Serbia thinking that Britain would not intervene.
- German's Weltpolitik since 1870 was a threat to world peace.
- She declared war on France
- She declared war on Russia

b) Austria-Hungary

- Austria-Hungary is blamed for declaring war on Serbia.
- She pursued a careless foreign policy towards the Balkans.
- She failed to respect the sovereignty of the Balkan states by annexing Bosnia and Herzegovina which angered Russia and Serbia thereby breeding hatred and grudge.
- She wanted to destroy Serbia once and for all.
- She made unreasonable demands meant to punish Serbia for the death of Archduke Francis Ferdinand.
- She supported the creation of an independent Albania at the treaty of London [1913] which created enmity with Serbia.
- Austria-Hungary made an agreement with Russia to partition the Balkans which angered

Serbia.

- She opposed the creation of a Russian backed Slav nation in Serbia.
- This would attract the support of the Slavs inside Austria-Hungary.
- She was involved in the system of alliances.
- She involved herself in the Balkans to make up for the losses in Italy and Germany [which became unified in 1861 and 1871 respectively]. On March 17, 1861, an all-Italian parliament proclaimed the Kingdom of Italy, with Victor Emmanuel as first king and Cavour as the first prime minister.

c) France

- She refused to remain neutral when Austria-Hungary declared war on Serbia and this forced Germany to declare war on France.
- She took part in arms race.
- She took part in militarism.
- She took part in the alliance system.
- France had a war plan called plan 17.

d) Russia

- She gave unrestricted support to Serbia making Serbia more reckless.
- She refused to remain neutral [and mobilised against Austria-Hungary] when Austria-Hungary declared war on Serbia and this forced Germany to declare war on her.
- She took part in arms race and militarism.
- It was opposed to Austrian and German influence in the Balkans.
- She was involved in the system of alliances.
- It protected other Slav peoples as it was the largest of Slav nations.
- It was hostile to Germany which ruled Polish Slavs.
- She made an agreement with Austria-Hungary that Austria-Hungary should take Bosnia and Herzegovina.
- She influenced the formation of the Balkan League.
- She supported Pan Slavism.

e) Britain

- She should be blamed for the arms race.
- She took part in the naval race.
- She supported France against Germany over Morocco in 1905 and 1911.
- She declared war on Germany on 4 August 1914.

f) Serbia

- She engineered the Sarajevo assassination which led to the outbreak of the 1914 general war.
- She sponsored anti-Austrian propaganda and terrorist activities in Austria-Hungary.